Market Monitor

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*The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers the international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations that form the AMIS Secretariat. Ultimately, the report aims at improving market transparency and detecting emerging problems that might warrant the attention of policy makers.*

Contents

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations IFAD Enabling poor rural people to overcome poverty IFPRI IGC OECD UNITED NATIONS UNCTAD WORLD BANK GROUP WFP wfp.org WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION

World Supply-Demand Outlook

The global cereal supply is proving to be exceptionally high this season in view of the latest upward adjustments to wheat and maize inventories. Soybean markets are also well supplied, as large production in 2014/15 is seen to result in strong accumulation of stocks. As a result, international prices for AMIS crops remained under downward pressure in March.

	From previous f'cast	From previous season
Wheat	▲	▲
Maize	▲	▲
Rice	▲	▼
Soybeans	▲	▲

▲ ***Easing*** ▬ ***Neutral*** ▼ ***Tightening***

million tonnes

WHEAT	**USDA**		**IGC**		**FAO-AMIS**		
	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 10-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 26-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 5-Mar*	2014/15 *f'cast 2-Apr*
Production	716	725	713	719	717	727	728
Supply	892	912	883	906	896	906	921
Utilization	704	715	696	708	692	704	711
Trade	166	161	155	153	157	151	151
Ending Stock	187	198	187	198	193	199	205

- **Wheat** production estimate in 2014 upgraded slightly, as a result of small increases in the CIS and South America.
- Utilization forecast for 2014/15 revised upwards, largely reflecting historical revisions in India.
- Trade forecast for 2014/15 revised up, on expectation of larger imports by several countries in Asia.
- Stocks (ending in 2015) raised, on higher expected inventories in China and Australia.

MAIZE	**USDA**		**IGC**		**FAO-AMIS**		
	2013/14 *est*	2014/15 *f'cast 10-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 26-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 5-Mar*	2014/15 *f'cast 2-Apr*
Production	990	990	991	990	1012	1022	1025
Supply	1125	1162	1121	1164	1163	1198	1213
Utilization	953	976	947	974	956	975	986
Trade	130	117	120	116	124	115	116
Ending Stock	172	185	174	191	188	210	219

- **Maize** production in 2014 adjusted upwards, on larger EU harvests.
- Utilization forecast for 2014/15 scaled up sharply, mainly in China.
- Trade forecast for 2014/15 reviewed slightly higher, on greater imports by several countries in Asia.
- Stocks (ending in 2015) raised significantly, following upward adjustments to historical carryover inventories in China more than offsetting downward revisions in India.

RICE *(milled)*	**USDA**		**IGC**		**FAO-AMIS**		
	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 10-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 26-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 5-Mar*	2014/15 *f'cast 2-Apr*
Production	477	475	476	475	497	496	494
Supply	587	581	588	585	673	676	675
Utilization	481	484	479	483	491	500	499
Trade	42	43	43	42	42	41	41
Ending Stock	106	98	110	101	181	176	177

- **Rice** production in 2014 cut somewhat, on a more pessimistic outlook for secondary crops in Thailand.
- Utilization in 2014/15 also lowered slightly, mainly reflecting revisions to food consumption, but still expected to grow by 1.7 percent.
- Trade in 2015 to decline by 2 percent from this month's more buoyant estimate for 2014. Bangladesh, Indonesia, Philippines and Sri Lanka are behind the expected fall in 2015 global imports.
- Stocks (ending in 2015) raised slightly since last month but expected to contract by more than 4 million tonnes from the previous year.

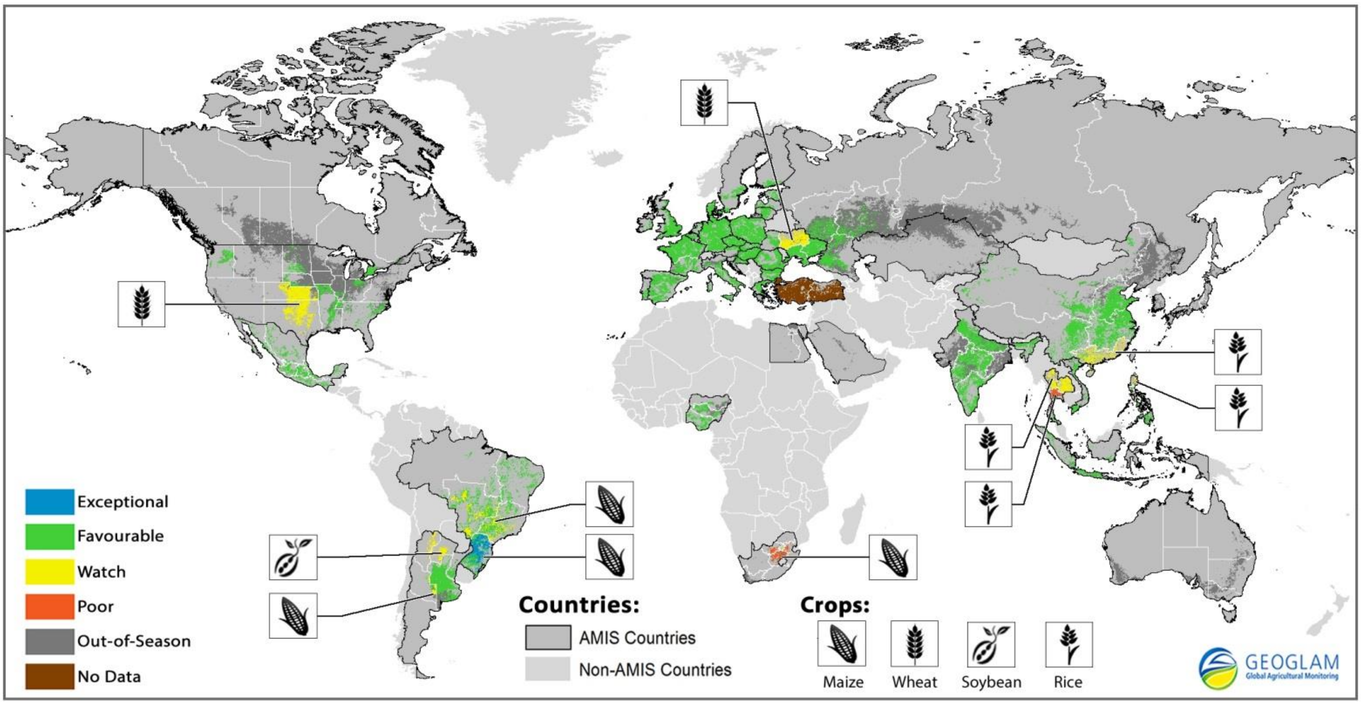
SOYBEANS	**USDA**		**IGC**		**FAO-AMIS**		
	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 10-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 26-Mar*	2013/14 *est.*	2014/15 *f'cast 5-Mar*	2014/15 *f'cast 2-Apr*
Production	284	315	285	314	284	314	312
Supply	341	381	312	344	311	344	344
Utilization	272	289	282	300	280	301	298
Trade	113	117	111	116	114	120	119
Ending Stock	66	90	30	44	32	42	46

- **Soybean** production in 2014/15 reduced slightly amid unfavourable weather in parts of South America, but still anticipated to end 10 percent above last year.
- Utilization set to expand by 6 percent in 2014/15, faster than in the previous two seasons.
- Trade forecast cut, reflecting smaller export availabilities in South America and lower imports for China and other Asian countries.
- Stocks (2014/15 carry-out) forecast to rebound sharply, primarily on account of the United States, Brazil and Argentina.

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies. All changes, in absolute or percentage terms, reported in the supply/demand commentaries are calculated based on unrounded figures. For more information see the last page of this report.

Crop Monitor

Crop Conditions in AMIS countries (as of March 28th)



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of March 28th. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. ***Crops that are in other than favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.***

Highlights

Wheat- In the northern hemisphere winter wheat has mostly resumed vegetative growth and conditions are generally favourable. In the EU, conditions are generally good. In the US there is still concern due to dry conditions in the Southern Plains. In China, conditions are favourable and in the Russian Federation and Ukraine, conditions remain mostly favourable though some concern remains over dry establishment conditions in the autumn. In Canada and India, conditions are mostly favourable.

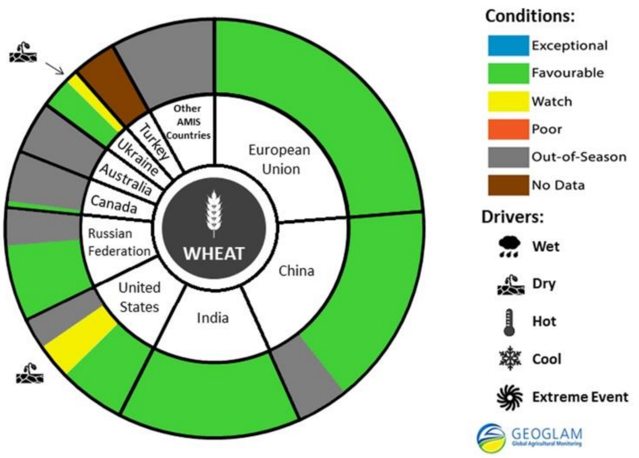
Maize- In the southern hemisphere, conditions are generally favourable. In Brazil conditions have improved and are favourable overall for the two maize crops. In Argentina conditions are favourable. In South Africa, below-normal yields are expected for both white and yellow maize. In the northern hemisphere, conditions are favourable for the newly planted crops in China and Mexico, as well as in India where harvest is almost complete.

Rice- Conditions are overall still favourable. In China, conditions are favourable for the early rice though there is concern for the single cropped rice in the south west due to excessive moisture. In Thailand, dry season rice conditions are poor due to water deficiency and planted area is significantly down. In India, Viet-Nam, Indonesia, Nigeria and Brazil, overall conditions are favourable. In the Philippines, dry season rice conditions have deteriorated and yields are expected to be slightly down relative to last year.

Soybeans- In the southern hemisphere, conditions remain favourable. In Brazil, despite earlier concerns over dryness, conditions are favourable and harvest is in progress. In Argentina, conditions remain mostly favourable except for a few areas in the north that suffered water excess.

Wheat In the *northern hemisphere* winter wheat has mostly resumed vegetative growth and conditions are mostly favourable. In the **EU**, winter wheat conditions are generally good. The crop is well developed owing to the mild winter conditions and prospects are promising. In the **US**, the crop has resumed vegetative growth and is progressing normally, however, concern continues in the southern Great Plains due to dry conditions. In **China**, winter wheat conditions are favourable and the crop is between vegetative in the North China Plain to jointing stages in the Middle and Lower Reaches of Yangtze River. In the **Russian Federation**, conditions of winter wheat remain mostly favourable. The crop started to break dormancy under warmer than usual and sunny conditions at the start of the month, though temperatures dropped in mid-march slowing vegetative growth. Some concern still remains over dry establishment conditions in the fall. In **Canada**, conditions are favourable for the dormant crop. Western Canada, where the majority of winter wheat is planted, experienced warmer than normal temperatures and below normal snowfall, which may lead to some winter-kill. The amount of winter wheat planted in Western Canada last fall was lower than expected, largely due to a late harvest. Eastern Canada has experienced colder than normal temperatures and below normal snowfall, which may also result in some winter-kill and affect growth in the spring. In India, conditions are mostly favourable except in the northern regions where there continue to be localized areas of moisture stress. In **Ukraine**, winter wheat has resumed vegetative growth, and conditions are generally favourable. Some concern remains over the unfavourable autumn establishment conditions, though moisture conditions are improving and are better than last year particularly in southern regions, which is the drier part of the country.

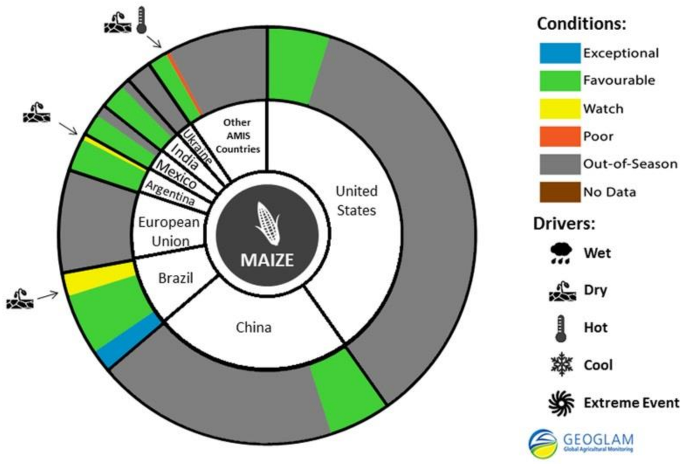
Wheat conditions for AMIS countries as of March 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box on page 4.

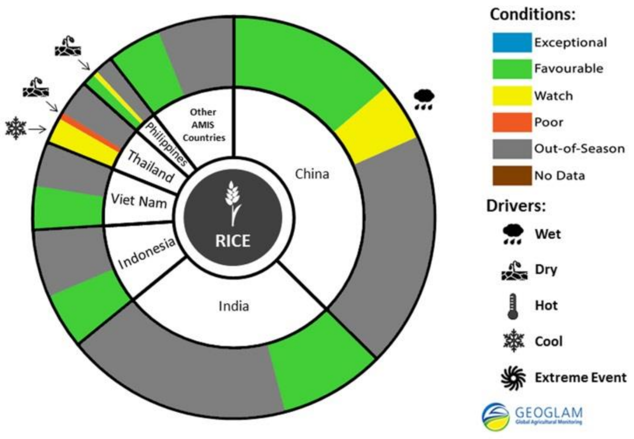
Maize In the *southern hemisphere*, conditions are generally favourable. In **Brazil**, overall conditions have improved and are favourable. Harvest is complete for the spring-planted crop (lesser producing season). Area planted is reduced relative to last year due to competition with soybeans and production is expected to be lower than last season. Planting of the summer-planted crop (higher producing season) is complete and conditions are favourable with recent rains supporting development. Despite the reduction in planted area, production is expected to reach similar levels as last year, owing to anticipated increased yields. In **Argentina**, conditions are favourable in most regions. There is some concern over lack of moisture in the central region and over water excesses in northern regions. Nevertheless, harvest has begun for the early-planted crop with good prospects. In **South Africa**, despite recent widespread rains, below-normal yields are expected for both white and yellow maize as result of hot and dry conditions during the first half of February. In the *northern hemisphere*, conditions are favourable. In **China**, conditions are favourable for spring-planted maize. In **Mexico**, favourable crop conditions continue throughout the country owing to good weather conditions and sufficient rainfall. Harvest of the spring-summer cycle is complete with good prospects. Sowing for the autumn-winter cycle has begun and planted area has increased in the northwest region. In **India**, harvest is almost complete and conditions are favourable.

Maize conditions for AMIS countries as of March 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box on page 4.

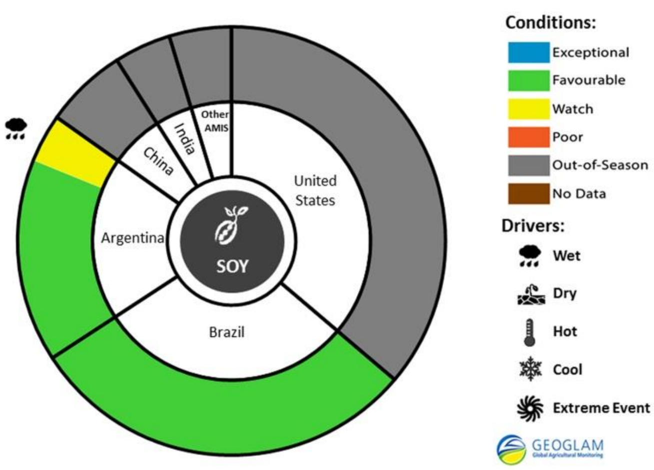
Rice conditions for AMIS countries as of March 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box below.

Rice conditions are overall still favourable. In **India**, conditions are favourable for the second season crop. In **China**, conditions are mixed. Early rice and single cropped rice are generally between seedling stages to transplanting stages. Conditions for early rice, mainly grown in southern China, are unfavorable due to excessive precipitation. Conditions for single cropped rice in the south west, are favourable. In **Thailand**, dry season rice conditions are poor to water deficiency and planted area is significantly down relative to last year. In northern regions there is also concern due to cold weather earlier in the season that led to sterility. In **Viet Nam**, overall conditions are favourable. Sowing of the dry season crop is complete and area is similar to last year. In **Indonesia**, conditions continue to be good for the wet season crop, owing to favourable sunlight and water availability for irrigation. The crop is in vegetative to maturity stages. Planted area is down relative to last year due to a delay in the start of the rainy season. In **Brazil**, harvest is in progress and conditions are favourable. Reduced planted area is compensated for with an increase in yields and therefore production is expected to be similar to last year. In **the Philippines**, dry season rice conditions have deteriorated and yields are expected to be slightly down relative to last year due to a combination of factors including heat, dry conditions, wind damage and pests. Harvest is currently in progress. In **Nigeria**, conditions are favourable for irrigated rice.

Soy Conditions for AMIS countries as of March 28th.



For detailed description of the pie chart please see box below.

Soybeans In the *southern hemisphere*, conditions are favourable. In **Brazil**, conditions are favourable and harvest is in progress. Despite earlier concerns over lack of rain in part of the Southeast, Midwest and Northeast, overall productivity is expected to increase relative to last year. Accounting for the increase in planted area, national production may be significantly higher than last year. In **Argentina**, conditions remain mostly favourable. The first crop is in grain filling to maturity stages, and the second crop is flowering or filling grains. The northern areas suffered water excess, but the impacts have not been evaluated yet.

Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average). Main producing countries (representing 90 percent of production) are shown individually, with the remaining 10 percent grouped into the “Other AMIS Countries” category. The area within each slice is divided between crops in-season (colour) and out-of-season (gray). The in-season portion is coloured according to the various crop conditions within that country. When conditions are labelled as 'poor' or 'watch', icons are added that provide information on the key climatic drivers affecting conditions. The coloured areas reflect conditions by area rather than overall national production.

Policy Developments

WHEAT

- **China** to maintain purchase prices for wheat in 2015. Approximately 850,000 tonnes of domestic wheat and 30,000 tonnes of US wheat were sold from government stocks in March 2015.
- From 1 April, the price of milling wheat sold to domestic millers in **Japan** will be increased by 3 percent on average to YEN 60,070 (USD 501).
- The **Russian Federation** has procured over 427,000 tonnes of grains in intervention tenders since 30 September 2014.
- On 13 March, **South Africa** increased its import tariff on wheat from ZAR 157 (USD 13) per tonne to ZAR 461 (USD 38) per tonne.
- The **EU** on March 12 awarded licenses to import 45,003 tonnes of Ukrainian wheat under an annual duty-free quota, which brings the awarded volume to 309,437 tonnes out of a total volume of 950,000 tonnes available in 2015.

RICE

- **China** to maintain purchase prices for rice in 2015.
- From 1 April 2015, two million tonnes of rice will be sold from government stocks on the open market in **India**. In October 2015, private millers will no longer be authorised to undertake procurement for the public distribution system. The rice quota under the Public Distribution System was increased.
- **Indonesia** lowered its target for 2015 government purchases of domestic rice from 3.2 to a bracket of 2.5 to 2.8 million tonnes. The distribution of 400,000 tonnes of rice from domestic stocks was started, of which 19,000 tonnes will be distributed at subsidised prices as part of a subsidised food programme.
- **Thailand** sold 770,000 tonnes of rice in the second tender for 2015 that was held on 6 March.
- **Viet Nam** reduced its minimum export price for 25 percent broken rice by approximately 3 percent to around USD 350 per tonne. This follows a previous reduction from USD 380 per tonne to USD 360 per tonne that occurred in January 2015.

BIOFUELS

- **Thailand** on January 20, 2015 lowered the mandatory content of vegetable oil-based biodiesel in diesel fuel by 50 percent from 7 to 3.5 percent.
- On March 5, 2015, **Brazil** announced the increase of the mandatory blending requirements for ethanol in regular gasoline, from 25 to 27 percent. This measure entered into force on 16 March 2015. The blending requirement for premium gasoline remains unchanged at 25 percent.

ACROSS THE BOARD

- **China** announced that CNY 154.6 billion (USD 25 billion) will be spent on stockpiling of grains and other commodities in 2015. Also in China, the growth of chemical fertiliser use has been capped to 1 percent annually between 2015-2019.
- **EU member states** were granted the flexibility to restrict or prohibit the cultivation of a genetically modified organism (GMO) or of a group of GMOs in all or parts of their territory, with transitional measures introduced as of 2 April 2015.

International Prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Mar 2015 Average*	% Change M/M	% Change Y/Y
GOI	204	- 3.2%	- 23.1%
Wheat	198	- 2.0%	- 21.5%
Maize	181	- 2.0%	- 25.7%
Rice	166	- 0.7%	- 7.3%
Soybeans	197	- 4.9%	- 27.8%

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

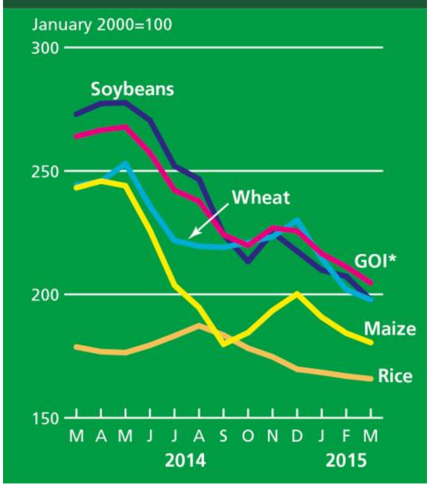
Wheat: World wheat export prices were mostly weak during March, pressured by large supplies and strong export competition. A generally favourable outlook for 2015 production was negative for prices, although worries mounted about crops in some regions, particularly in the US and CIS. Despite better crop conditions than last season, persistent dryness was of some concern in the US, contributing to rising export quotations from that origin. With the pace of export shipments much slower than previously, values eased in the Black Sea region. Despite some uncertainty about the outlook for 2015 production there, initial new crop export quotations were very competitive relative to other exporters.

Maize: The IGC GOI maize sub-Index fell to its lowest levels since October. The weaker tone reflected a comfortable outlook for world supplies, including in South America, where crop prospects remained mostly favourable. Despite some early harvesting delays in Argentina, quotations there showed comparatively steep declines as traders looked to secure fresh sales. While exporters in Brazil concentrated on shipping soybeans, maize prices for transit later in the year are competitive and some deals were signed. Although average US prices were softer, quotations began to firm late in the month on outside market influences and lingering cool, wet weather ahead of spring planting.

Rice: Asian white and parboiled rice export prices were marginally weaker during March in mostly quiet activity. While fresh sales to the Philippines and reports of renewed buying interest from China provided mild underpinning, particularly in Thailand and Vietnam, markets were pressured by the arrival of new crop supplies and continuing efforts by the Thai government to release state reserves. Elsewhere, broken rice export values in South America eased as harvesting progressed.

Soybeans: Combining of expected record South American crops remained an underlying bearish feature over the past month, more than offsetting occasional support from logistical difficulties in Brazil and fresh buying interest from China. Ideas that US plantings for the 2015/16 harvest were likely to expand to a new peak pressured at times, as did external market influences, most notably US dollar strength. With a switch to cheaper new crop values in Argentina accentuating overall declines, the IGC GOI soybeans sub-Index fell by around five percent m/m.

IGC Commodity Price Indices



IGC commodity price indices

		GOI*	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(January 2000 = 100)				
2014	March	**264.0**	244.3	243.2	178.7	273.0
	April	**266.5**	245.7	245.9	176.8	277.3
	May	**267.8**	253.0	244.0	176.4	277.6
	June	**257.3**	235.7	225.9	179.4	270.5
	July	**242.2**	221.8	203.7	183.2	252.0
	August	**237.7**	219.5	194.7	187.3	246.7
	September	**224.2**	219.1	179.8	183.5	224.3
	October	**219.8**	221.0	184.5	178.2	213.3
	November	**226.9**	223.4	193.5	174.7	225.1
	December	**225.7**	230.0	200.2	169.7	217.5
2015	January	**216.5**	214.4	190.8	168.4	209.8
	February	**211.2**	202.0	184.3	166.9	207.3
	March	**204.7**	197.8	180.5	165.8	197.7

*GOI: Grains and Oilseeds Index

Futures Markets

Futures Prices - nearby

	Mar 2015 Average	% Change M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	187	- 1.7%	-25.1%
Maize	151	- 0.2%	-20.6%
Rice	232	0.4%	-31.2%
Soybeans	360	-1.4%	-31.1%

Source: CME – USD per tonne

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages Mar 2015	Feb 2015	Mar 2014
Wheat	29.0%	25.1%	30.2%
Maize	20.1%	24.3%	18.8%
Rice	24.6%	26.0%	16.4%
Soybeans	18.4%	20.4%	17.0%

Futures Prices

Prices for wheat, maize, soybeans declined marginally m/m as fundamentals remained unchanged and market participants awaited the USDA March 31 report on producer planting intentions. Rice, which has experienced a year-long price decline, rose modestly. Soybean prices remained subdued as bumper South American crops were confirmed. A strong US dollar and low energy prices were moderating factors in maize prices. In addition to the upcoming USDA report, April weather developments across the Midwest growing regions and winter wheat emergence from dormancy in the major Northern Hemisphere producing countries were cited as the next focus for the market. Overall, prices were down 20 – 30 percent y/y. Following the release of the March 31 USDA report during the CME trading session, maize and wheat dropped about five percent and three percent respectively, while and soybean prices rose modestly.
In a business development matter, the CME announced that it was experiencing difficulty in launching an European based wheat futures contract to compete with the existing French based NYSE-Euronext wheat contract. CME cited obstacles in securing agreements with various silo operators to serve as physical delivery centers.

Volumes and Volatility

Volumes decreased m/m by over 30 percent for maize and soybeans and for wheat by over 20 percent, as is typical during the month preceding the spring planting season. Implied Volatility rose marginally for wheat, maize and soybeans.

Forward curves

Forward curves for wheat and maize maintained their mostly upward sloping structures (contango), indicating ample supplies for the remainder of this crop year and next. The price structure in soybeans is moderately wavy, particularly for successive crop years. This pattern is a normal structure for most crop years - reflecting ample harvest supplies and relative tightness at season's end.

Basis levels

Interior basis levels in US displayed little change m/m despite slight strengthening in export values, particularly for soybeans. Barge shipments along the Ohio River decreased as the river swelled above flood stage owing to the significant snowfall amounts in the eastern half of the US. Elsewhere, barge transportation rates remained below three-year averages. The rail industry benefited from reduced fuel surcharges as a result of lower oil and diesel prices.

Investment flows

Managed money was a substantial net seller of wheat, maize and soybeans, establishing short positions in all three commodities for the first time since the CFTC began issuing the disaggregated Commitment of Traders report (2006). The maize market exhibited the most aggressive selling; during the first two weeks in March, managed money reversed its net long position to short with net sales of approximately 125,000 contracts, equivalent to 16m tonnes. Dollar strength in the first half March and expectations of a bearish USDA March 31 report (quarterly stocks and planting intentions) tended to fuel selling.

For more information on technical terms please view the Glossary at the following link:
http://www.amis-outlook.org/fileadmin/user_upload/amis/docs/Market_monitor/Glossary.pdf

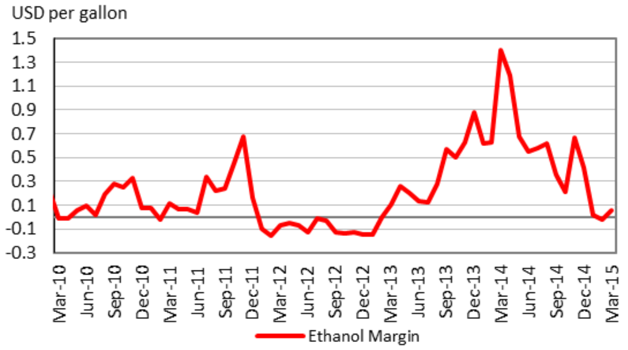
Monthly US Ethanol Update

- Ethanol production, while down slightly from the annualized pace of last month, continues to run well above one year ago levels.
- Ethanol prices have increased as gasoline prices have rebounded in recent weeks.
- Slightly stronger maize prices have resulted in only modest increases in maize feedstock costs for ethanol producers.
- With higher ethanol prices and only fractionally higher maize prices, ethanol margins have improved somewhat, but remain well below levels seen for much of 2014.
- The Renewable Fuel Standard remains in flux as the EPA has yet to release mandates for last year (2014) or the current year (2015) but has announced intentions to release mandates for 2014-2016 in the coming months.

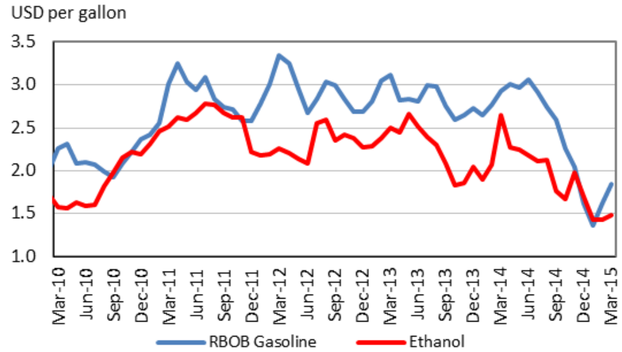
Spot prices IA, NE and IL/eastern *corn belt* average	**Mar 2015***	**Feb 2015**	**Mar 2014**
Maize price (USD per tonne)	148.92	147.93	183.48
DDGs (USD per tonne)	195.19	197.27	262.70
Ethanol price (USD per gallon)	1.43	1.34	2.91
Nearby futures prices CME, NYSE			
Ethanol (USD per gallon)	1.49	1.43	2.65
RBOB Gasoline (USD per gallon)	1.84	1.61	2.93
Ethanol/RBOB price ratio	80.9%	89.0%	90.6%
Ethanol margins IA, NE and IL/eastern *corn belt* average, USD per gallon)			
Ethanol receipts	1.43	1.34	2.91
DDGs receipts	0.55	0.55	0.74
Maize costs	1.38	1.37	1.69
Other costs	0.55	0.55	0.55
Production margin	0.06	(0.02)	1.40
Ethanol production (million gallons)			
Monthly production total	1,248	1,129	1,181
Annualized production pace	14,690	14,720	13,904

Based on USDA data and private sources. * Estimated using available weekly data to date.

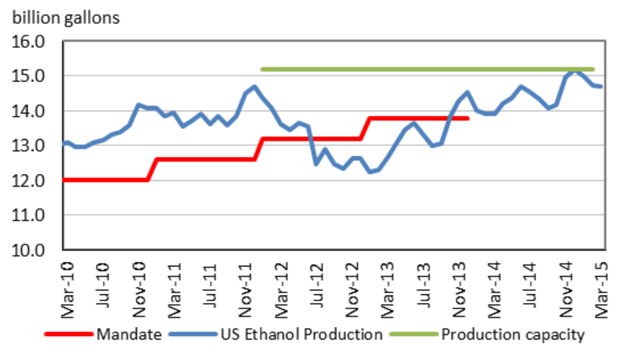
Ethanol Production Margin
(IA, NE, IL/eastern corn belt average)



Ethanol and RBOB gasoline
(nearby futures prices, CME, NYSE)



Ethanol production pace, capacity and annual mandate



Ethanol price vs. maize price
(Spot prices)

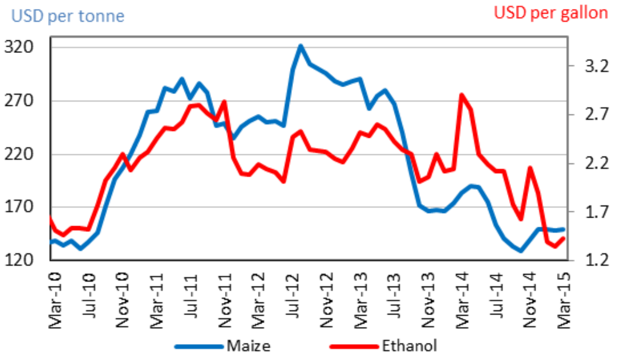


Chart and tables description:

Ethanol Production Margins: The ethanol margin gives an indication of the profitability of maize-based ethanol production in the United States. It uses current market prices for maize, Dried Distillers Grains (DDGs) and ethanol, with an additional USD 0.55 per gallon of production costs

Ethanol Production Pace, Capacity and Mandate: Overview of the volume of maize-based ethanol production in the United States; it also highlights overall production capacity and the production volume that is mandated by public legislation. Name-plate (i.e. nominal) ethanol production capacity in the US is roughly 14.9 billion gallons per annum, but plants can exceed this level, so the actual capacity is assumed to be 15.2 billion gallons.

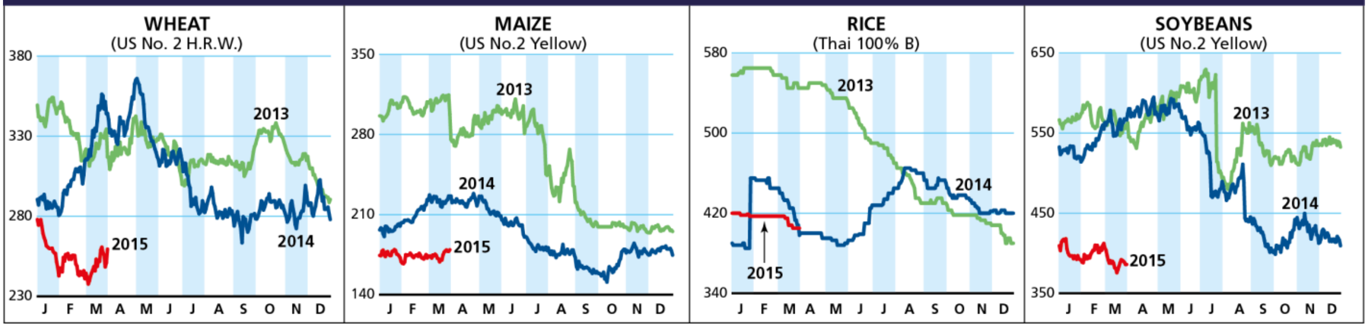
DDGs: By-product of maize-based biofuel production, commonly used as feedstuff.

RBOB: Reformulated Blendstock for Oxygenate Blending, gasoline nearby futures (NYSE).

Supplementary tables and charts

Selected Export Prices and Price Indices

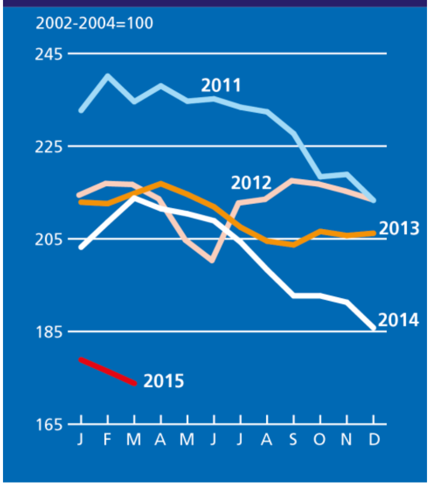
Daily quotations of selected export prices (USD/tonne, 2013-2015)



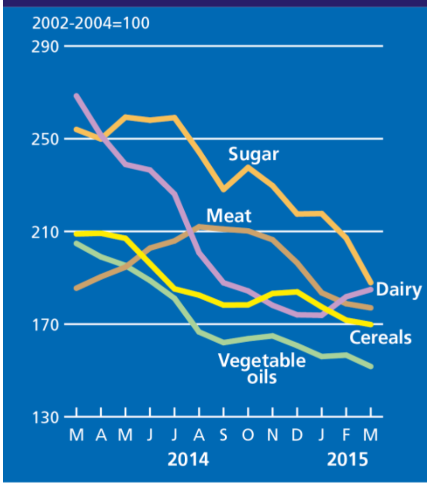
Daily quotations of selected export prices

	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Week ago (2)	Month ago (3)	Year ago (4)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (4)
	(. . . . USD/tonne	. . . .)					
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	30-Mar	260	261	246	344	-0.5%	-24.6%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	30-Mar	179	177	175	226	1.3%	-20.7%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	30-Mar	405	405	417	400	0.0%	1.3%
Soybeans (US No.2, Yellow)	30-Mar	386	392	412	575	-1.5%	-32.8%

FAO Food Price Index



FAO Food Commodity Price Indices



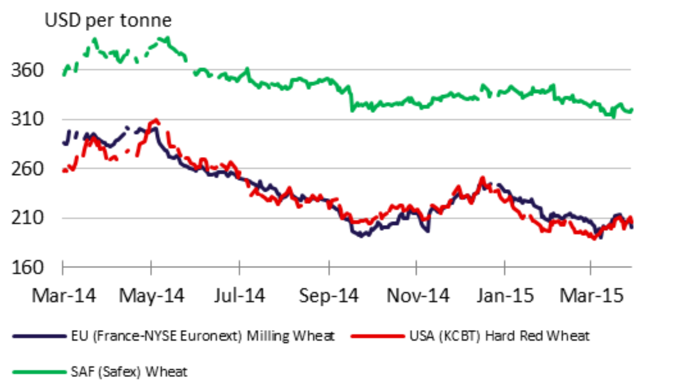
FAO food price indices

		Food Price Index	Meat	Dairy	Cereals	Oils and Fats	Sugar
		(.	. . . .	2002-2004 = 100	. . . .	. . . .	)
2014	March	**213.8**	185.5	268.5	208.9	204.8	254.0
	April	**211.5**	190.4	251.5	209.2	199.0	249.9
	May	**210.4**	194.6	238.9	207.0	195.3	259.3
	June	**208.9**	202.8	236.5	196.1	188.8	258.0
	July	**204.3**	205.9	226.1	185.2	181.1	259.1
	August	**198.3**	212.0	200.8	182.5	166.6	244.3
	September	**192.7**	211.0	187.8	178.2	162.0	228.1
	October	**192.7**	210.2	184.3	178.3	163.7	237.6
	November	**191.3**	206.4	178.1	183.2	164.9	229.7
	December	**185.8**	196.4	174.0	183.9	160.7	217.5
2015	January	**178.9**	183.5	173.8	177.4	156.0	217.7
	February	**176.4**	178.8	181.8	171.7	156.6	207.1
	March	**173.8**	177.0	184.9	169.8	151.7	187.9

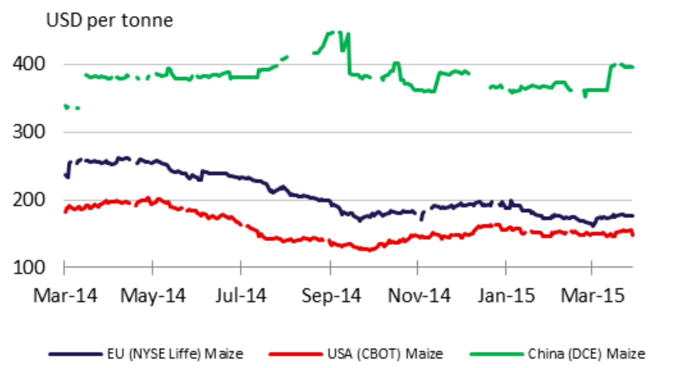
Market Indicators

Daily Quotations from Leading Exchanges - nearby futures

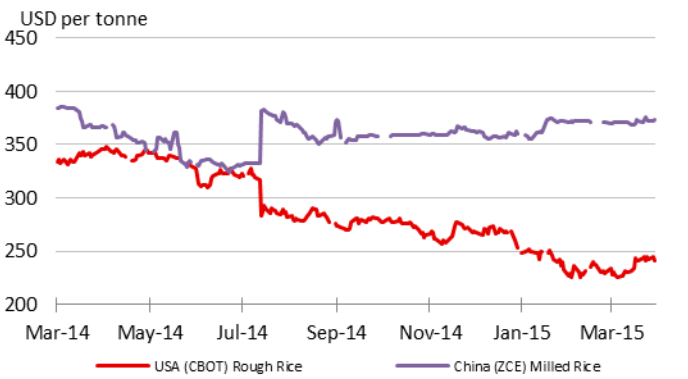
Wheat



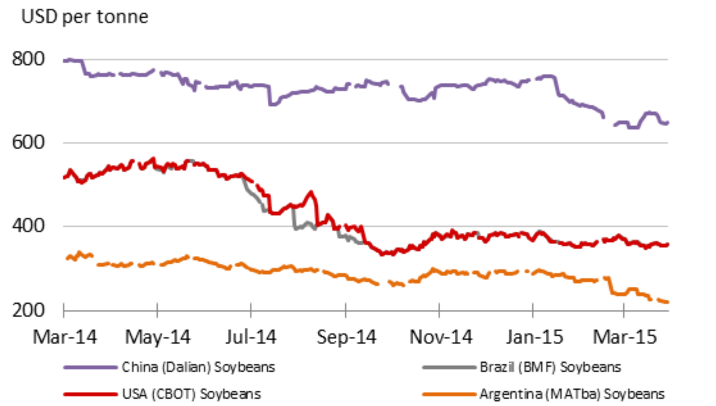
Maize



Rice

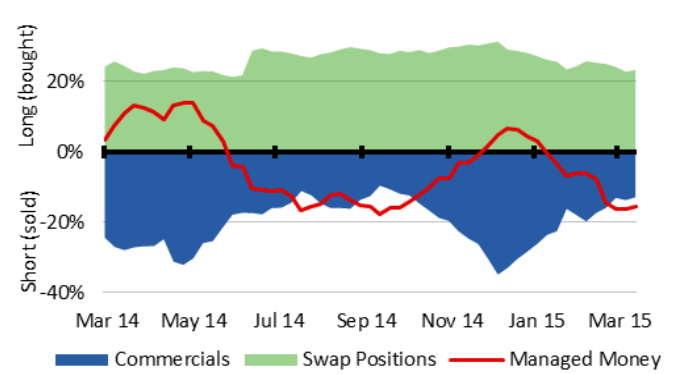


Soybeans

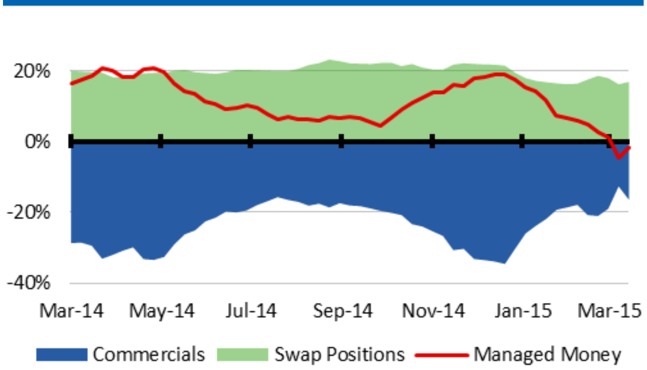


CFTC Commitment of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

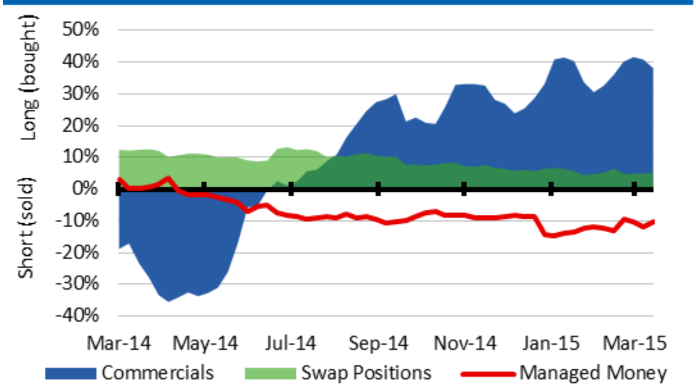
Wheat



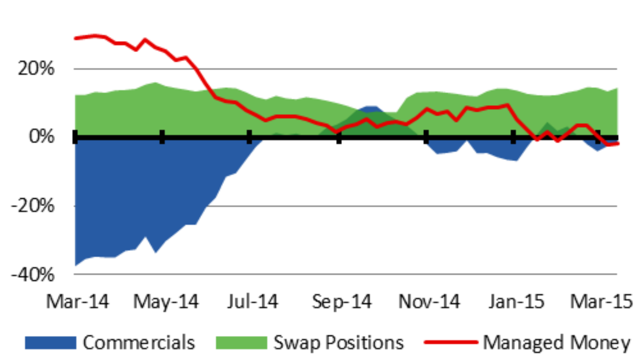
Maize



Rough Rice



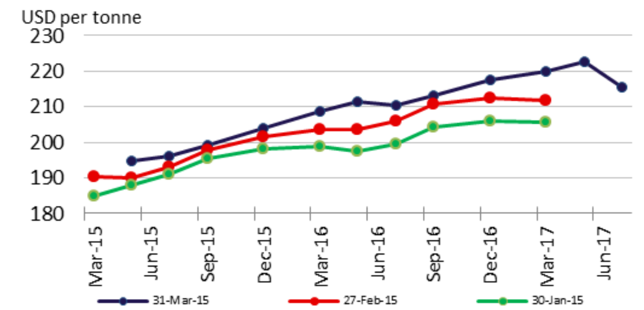
Soybeans



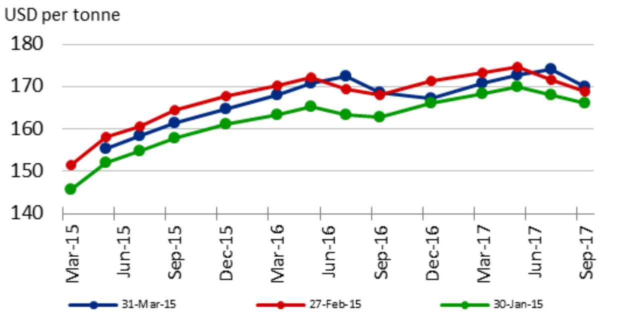
* Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.

Forward Curves

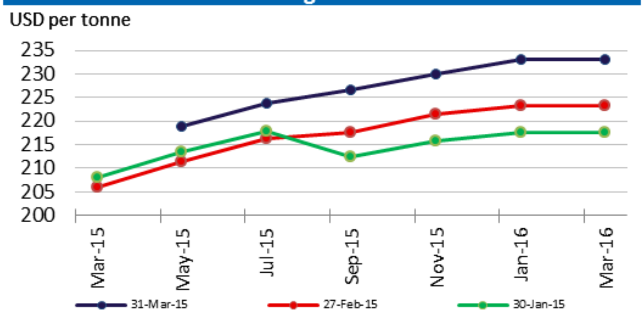
Wheat



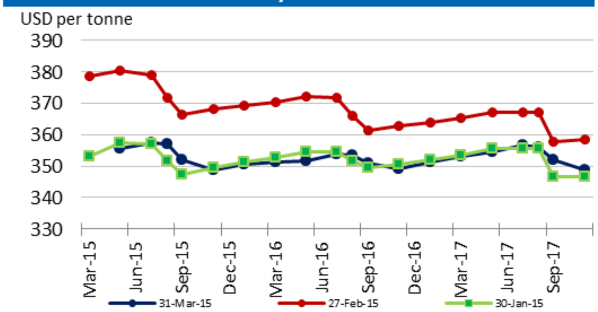
Maize



Rough Rice

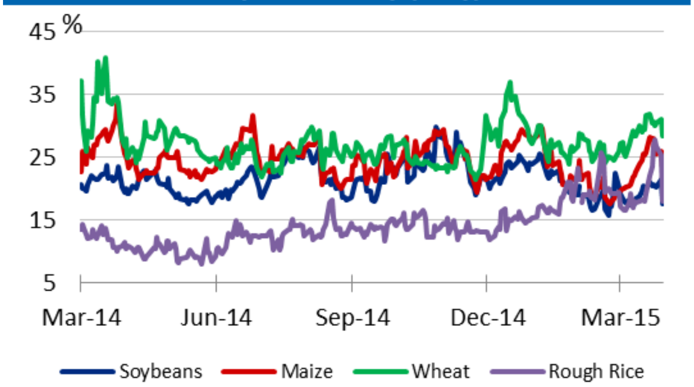


Soybeans

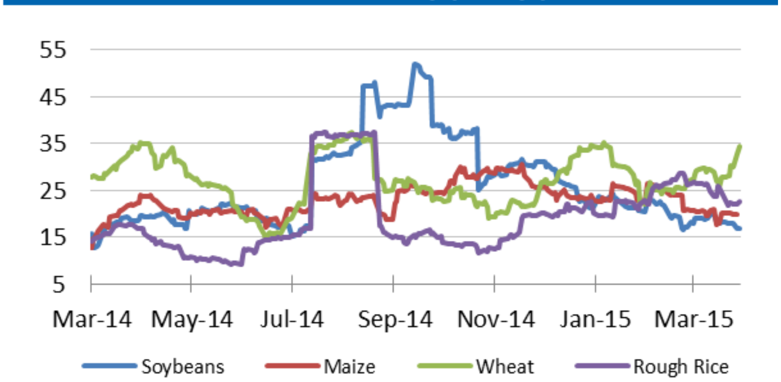


Historical and Implied Volatilities

Implied Volatility (Daily)



Historical Volatility (30 days)



Maize use for Ethanol in the US

Maize Use for Ethanol (excluding non-fuel) in the United States

	2005/06	2006/07	2007/08	2008/09	2009/10	2010/11	2011/12	2012/13	2013/14* estim.	2014/15* (f'cast)
					thousand tonnes					
Maize Production	282,263	267,503	331,177	307,142	332,550	316,166	313,956	273,188	351,270	361,101
Ethanol Use	40,726	53,837	77,453	93,396	116,616	127,538	127,005	117,886	130,409	132,085
Yearly ethanol use change (%)	21%	32%	44%	21%	25%	9.4%	-0.4%	-7.2%	10.6%	1.3%
As Production (%)	14%	20%	23%	30%	35%	40.3%	40.5%	43.1%	37.1%	36.6%

Source: WASDE-USDA. * 10 March 2015

AMIS Market Indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at: http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/

Explanatory Notes and Calendar

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of "**World Supply and Demand**" reflect judgmental views which take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts in this report are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA; for the former, they also take into account information received from AMIS countries (hence the notion "**FAO-AMIS**"). World estimates and forecasts may vary due to several reasons. Apart from different release dates, the three main sources may apply different methodologies to construct the elements of the balances. Specifically:

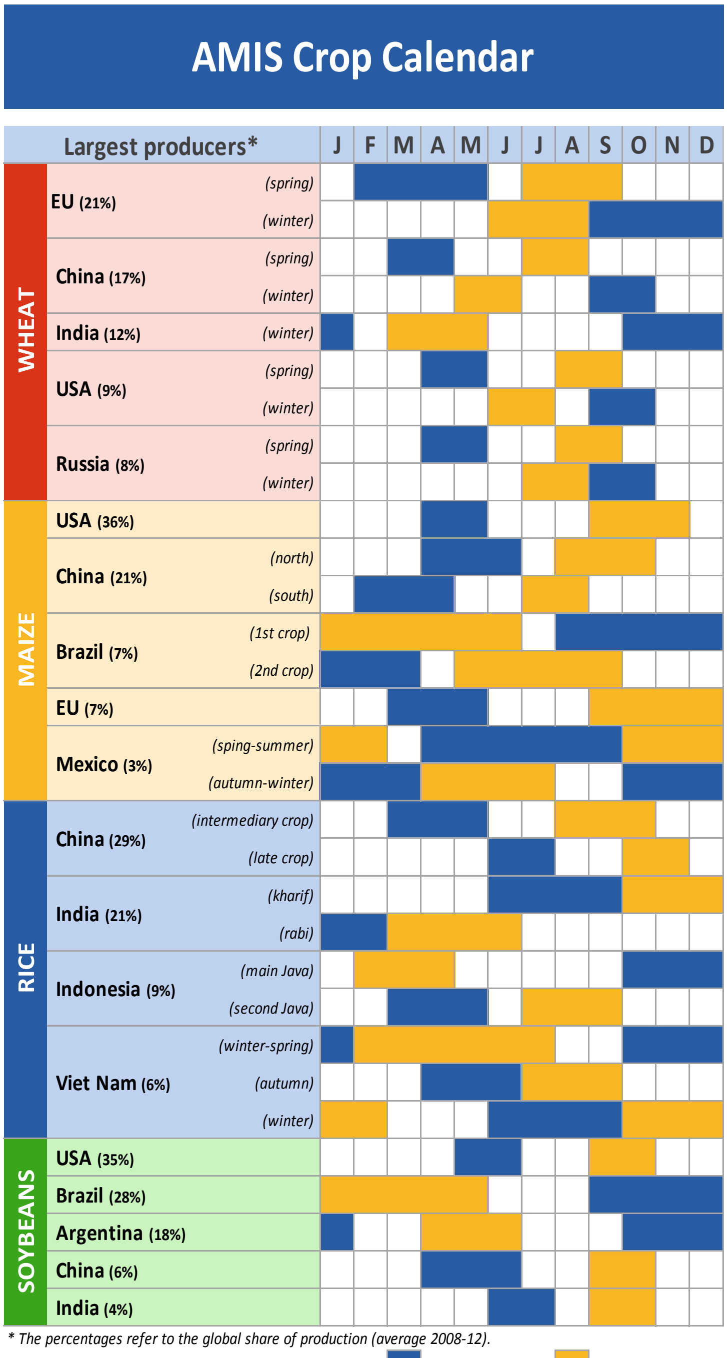
Production: For wheat, production data refer to the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. the 2014 production is allocated to the 2014/15 marketing season). For maize and rice, FAO-AMIS production data refer to the season corresponding to the first year shown, as for wheat. However, in the case of rice, 2014 production also includes secondary crops gathered in 2015. By contrast, for rice and maize, USDA and IGC aggregate production of the northern hemisphere of the first year (e.g. 2014) with production of the southern hemisphere of the second year (2015 production) in the corresponding 2014/15 global marketing season. For soybeans, this latter method is used by all three sources.

Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks. No major differences across sources.

Utilization: For wheat, maize and rice, utilization includes food, feed and other uses ("other uses" comprise seeds, industrial utilization and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. No major differences across sources.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June marketing year basis, except for the USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. For rice, trade covers flows from January to December of the second year shown, and for soybeans from October to September. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Ending Stocks: In general, ending stocks refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. In the case of maize and rice, in southern hemisphere countries the definition of the national marketing year is not the same across the three sources as it depends on the methodology chosen to allocate production. For Soybeans, the USDA world stock level is based on an aggregate of stock levels as of 31 August for all countries, coinciding with the end of the US marketing season. By contrast, the IGC and FAO-AMIS measure of world stocks is the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year.



** The percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2008-12).*

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, Inter-Continental Exchange, IGC, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve, World Bank

2015 Release Dates

05 February, 05 March, 02 April, **07 May, 04 June, 09 July, 10 September, 08 October, 05 November, 03 December**

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